Manuel Holz

Quantitative Social Scientist · Data Scientist · Lecturer

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Chemnitz, Germany

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Associate
2017–present

Professorship Empirical Social Research, Chemnitz University of Technology

Research and teaching quantitative methods

Lecturer (temporary)
2025

Professorship Empirical Social Research, RPTU University Kaiserslautern-Landau

Introduction to social data analytics in R

PROJECTS

Norms in medical triage situations in the context of AI
2026–present

Medical treatment allocation preferences, discrete choice experiments.

Sponsor: Fritz Thyssen Foundation

Concepts for urban housing mobilization (Zukowo)
2026–present

Housing preferences, spatial data, vignette experiments, and interactive visualization.

Sponsor: Federal Ministry of Research, Technology and Space of Germany (BMFTR)

Come2Data - Competence Center for Interdisciplinary Data Sciences
2023–2026

Training and support in the fields of data integration, data management, data analysis and data publication

Sponsor: Federal Ministry of Research, Technology and Space of Germany (BMFTR, 16DKZ2044B)

COVID-19 Skepticism & Infection Dynamics
2022–2025

Longitudinal analysis combining survey, epidemiological and social media data

Sponsor: Development Bank of Saxony (SAB)

Societal acceptance of sustainable technologies 2019–2022

Two-wave panel on attitudes towards green technologies in housing

Sponsor: Federal Ministry of Research, Technology and Space of Germany (BMFTR, 033W108A-K)

EDUCATION

PhD in Sociology (*Dr. rer. soc.*) 2024

Chemnitz University of Technology

Dissertation: Explaining migrant health inequalities - selection, measurement invariance and working conditions in native-migrant health differences (*summa cum laude*)

Supervisors: **Prof. Dr. Jochen Mayerl, Prof. Dr. Peter Kriwy**

M.Sc. Socioeconomics 2017

University of Erlangen-Nuremberg

Thesis: Aspects of the Healthy Migrant Effect

Supervisors: **Prof. Dr. Andreas Damelang, Prof. Dr. Martin Abraham**

B.A. Socioeconomics 2014

University of Erlangen-Nuremberg

Supervisors: **Prof. Dr. Peter Kriwy, Prof. Dr. Monika Jungbauer-Gans**

ACADEMIC & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Communication Officer 2026–present

Research Network 21 Quantitative Methods (RN21) of the European Sociological Association (ESA)

Member, PPES Study Programme Committee 2025–present

Philosophy, Politics, Economics & Sociology (PPES)

Member, Deutschlandstipendium Scholarship Selection Committee 2023–present

Chemnitz University of Technology

Erasmus Exchange Coordinator 2018–present

Chemnitz University of Technology

Summer School 2025

Summer Institute in Computational Social Science, Paris

Certificate 2026

Nature Masterclass in Peer Review

Internship 2016

German Institute for Economic Research (DIW), Berlin

Web scraping of nuclear power plant data

Supervisors: **Prof. Dr. Claudia Kemfert, Prof. Dr. Christian von Hirschhausen**

Internship 2014

Institute for Empirical Sociology, Nuremberg

Data management and visualization of sustainable mobility data

Supervisor: **Prof. Dr. Walter Funk**

Exchange 2016

Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México

Exchange 2013

Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona

SKILLS

Programming
R · Python · SQL · STATA

Tools & workflow
Quarto · Git · LaTeX · VS Code

Languages
German (native) · English · French · Spanish · Italian · Russian

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Holz, M., Mayerl, J., & Kriwy, P. (2026). *The Social Dynamics of Pandemic Outcomes: Linking Social Media Discourse, Infection Rates, Political Attitudes and Health Beliefs.* SSRN (preprint) DOI: 10.2139/ssrn.7471201

Schwemmer, C., Block, S., Jaworeck, S., Holz, M., & Spielbauer, P. (2026). *Simplifying Sociology: When Complex Writing Occurs, Where It Matters, and How It Can Be Improved.* OSF (preprint) DOI: /10.31235/osf.io/7gjzf_v2

Holz, M., Andersen, H., & Mayerl, J. (2026). *Visualizing Data for Social Science Research: An Applied Introduction with R.* Springer VS DOI: 10.1007/978-3-658-50878-4

Holz, M., Gränitz, J., Mayerl, J., & Kriwy, P. (2026). *Computational Approaches to Assessing the Influence of Social Media Discourse on Pandemic Attitudes.* Soziale Welt Special Volume: Computational Social Science: Current Trends and State of the Art.

Zehner, A. H., Fölsch, M., Menold, N., Holz, M., Maskow, B., & Mayerl, J. (2026). *Foreigners welcome? Categorizing change in German mass media discourse with Latent Semantic Analysis (LSA).* PLOS ONE, 21(2), e0340164. DOI: 10.1371/journal.pone.0340164

Holz, M., & Mayerl, J. (2025). *Can Differing Occupational Class Positions Explain Migrant Health Inequalities? Differences in Trajectories of Subjective Health Between Migrants and Native Germans over Time.* KZfSS Kölner Zeitschrift für Soziologie und Sozialpsychologie, 77(1), 27–52. DOI: 10.1007/s11577-025-00985-3

Holz, M., & Mayerl, J. (2024). *Migrant Health Inequalities or Unequal Measurements? Testing for Cross-cultural and Longitudinal Measurement Invariance of Subjective Physical and Mental Health.* Methods,

data, analyses: a journal for quantitative methods and survey methodology, 18(1), 59–78. DOI: 10.12758/mda.2024.01

Holz, M. (2022). *Health inequalities in Germany: Differences in the 'Healthy migrant effect' of European, non-European and internal migrants.* Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies, 48(11), 2620–2641. DOI: 10.1080/1369183X.2021.1901675

Holz, M., Mayerl, J., Andersen, H., & Maskow, B. (2022). *How does migration background affect COVID-19 vaccination intentions? A complex relationship between general attitudes, religiosity, acculturation and fears of infection.* Frontiers in Public Health, 10, 854146. DOI: 10.3389/fpubh.2022.854146

SELECTED CONFERENCE CONTRIBUTIONS

2025. *Contextualizing surveys: Incorporating digital trace and media data.* Session Chair, European Survey Research Association (ESRA), Utrecht, Netherlands.

Holz, M., Zehner, A., & Mayerl, J. (2026). *Did Gen Z Stop Loving University? Changing Perceptions of University Education Among Adolescent Cohorts – Evidence from Longitudinal Data.* Presentation, European Sociological Association (ESA), Warsaw, Poland.

Holz, M., Planche, V., Buder, C., Tolepbergen, M., & Belgroun, H. (2026). *Constructing the AI Narrative: Techno-Optimism and Techno-Pessimism in Wikipedia's Discourse on Technological Issues.* Presentation, European Sociological Association (ESA), Warsaw, Poland.

Holz, M., Maskow, B., Mayerl, J., Zehner, A., & Menold, N. (2025). *Predicting migrant acceptance: Investigating the impact of social media discourse on public perceptions of migration.* Presentation, International Sociological Association (ISA) RC33 Conference, Naples, Italy. DOI: 10.13140/RG.2.2.16156.55683

Holz, M., & Mayerl, J. (2025). *Lost in translation? Migration, panel attrition and language versions in health surveys: Evidence from the German Socio-Economic Panel.* Presentation, Between Data and Dialogue: Focusing on Participants in Migration Research – IMISCOE Workshop, Chemnitz, Germany.

Jaworeck, S., & Holz, M. (2023). *Different methods, but same results? A comparison of Causal Forest and Propensity Score Matching on health disparities between natives and migrants.* Presentation, Analytical Sociology: Theory and Empirical Applications, Venice, Italy.

Holz, M., Adebahr, P., Mayerl, J., & Kriwy, P. (2023). *Merging Survey, Epidemiological and Twitter Data: Challenges of data integration (and implications for model effects).* Presentation, European Survey Research Association (ESRA), Milan, Italy.

Holz, M., & Mayerl, J. (2023). *A gender jab gap? COVID-19 vaccination intention and the interplay of migration background and gender.* Presentation, Institute for Employment Research (IAB) Networking Meeting on Migration and Gender, Nuremberg, Germany.